



C1 · ADVANCED · ÜNİTE 1



The Architecture of Thought

Grammar: Ellipsis, Substitution & Nominal Clauses (What/That/Whether)

Ad Soyad: _____

Sınıf / Tarih: _____

Puan: _____ / 15

Dil ve düşünce temasıyla What / The fact that / Whether ile kurulan isim cümleciklerini ve so, not, do gibi tekrar önleyici ellipsis-substitution yapılarını öğreniyorsun.

1 · Kelimeler

2 · Grammar

3 · Okuma

4 · Alıştırmalar

5 · Yazma

Cevap anahtarı

1 Vocabulary · Kelimeler

#	WORD / CHUNK	TÜRKÇE AÇIKLAMA
1	What + clause + is...	Ne/Kim olan şey... — pseudo-cleft nominal subject
2	The fact that + clause	...olduğu gerçeği — nominal clause as subject/object
3	It goes without saying	Söylemene gerek yok, açıktır — fixed idiom
4	take for granted	Sorgulamadan kabul etmek — assume without reflection
5	call into question	Sorgulatmak, şüphe uyandırmak
6	give credence to	İnandırıcılık kazandırmak
7	bear out	Doğrulamak, desteklemek (evidence bears out a claim)
8	predicated on	...ye dayalı, ...yi varsayan (an argument predicated on)
9	the extent to which	Ne ölçüde, ne derece (formal nominal clause)
10	nuanced / a nuanced view	Nüanslı — ince ayrımlı, basitleştirilmemiş

2 Grammar · Grammar

Nominal Clauses — İsim Cümleleri

Nominal (isim) cümleleri, bir cümlede **özne, nesne veya tümleç** görevini üstlenen yan cümleciklerdir. C1 düzeyi akademik yazımda cümlelere derinlik ve karmaşıklık katar. Türkçe'deki "-dığı, -acağı, -mesi" ekleri gibi işlev görür.



Nominal clause türleri

Tür	Yapı	Örnek
What clause	What + S + V	What concerns me most is the lack of transparency.

Tür	Yapı	Örnek
That clause	that + S + V	It is clear that action is needed .
The fact that	The fact that + S + V	The fact that no one was informed is troubling.
Whether clause	whether + S + V	The question is whether we can afford it .
How/Why clause	how/why + S + V	How the data was collected remains unclear.

Özne konumunda nominal clause

What clause — özne

What I find remarkable is her resilience.

What the data shows is deeply worrying.

What we need is a long-term solution.

That / whether — nesne

I believe **that the policy is flawed**.

She questioned **whether the data was reliable**.

He admitted **that he had been wrong**.



TIP — Cleft sentences ile güç

Nominal clause + cleft = C1 seviyesi güç:

Sade: "The timing matters most."

C1: "**What matters most** is the timing."

Sade: "Lack of funding caused the failure."

C1: "**What caused the failure** was the lack of funding."

3 Reading · Okuma

Does Language Shape Thought?

What linguists have long debated is whether language shapes thought or merely expresses it — a question far more profound than it might initially appear.

The fact that different languages encode reality in fundamentally different ways **gives credence** to the hypothesis that language influences cognition. The linguist Benjamin Lee Whorf famously claimed that the Hopi language of the American Southwest has no words or grammatical forms that refer to time as English does — **what this implies** remains disputed, and later research by Ekkehart Malotki strongly challenged the claim. The Pirahã people of the Amazon speak a language that, according to the controversial research of Daniel Everett, appears to lack recursion entirely — **which would mean** they cannot embed one thought inside another.

What we take for granted — the assumption that language and thought are entirely separable processes — is precisely **what this research calls into question**. The **extent to which** language, culture, and cognition are

intertwined remains one of psychology's most genuinely **nuanced** and unresolved questions.

Some linguists argue the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis is dead, **predicated on** poor methodology. Others **bear out** weaker versions of it with careful experiments. **Whether** colour perception, spatial reasoning, or time orientation can be altered by language structure **remains to be established** definitively.

It goes without saying that **the fact that** we are even asking this question reveals something important: **what we believe** about the relationship between language and mind shapes everything else — our theories of education, consciousness, artificial intelligence, and cross-cultural understanding. **What is certain** is that the debate is far from over.

İ Gerçek olay ve araştırmalara dayanır; ders amacıyla sadeleştirilmiştir.

Kaynaklar:

- Everett (2005), Current Anthropology — Pirahã — <https://www.journals.uchicago.edu/doi/10.1086/431525>
- Linguistic relativity — Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy — <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/relativism/>

Comprehension Questions

1. What have linguists long debated?

2. What is unusual about the Pirahã language of the Amazon?

3. What does the text say 'we take for granted'?

4. Find 3 nominal clauses starting with 'What' in the text and explain what grammatical role each plays (subject/object/complement).

4 Exercises · Alıştırmalar

Doğru seçeneği işaretleyin.

- ___ matters most is not talent but consistent effort.
(a) What (b) That (c) Which
- The fact ___ he had lied damaged trust irreparably.
(a) that (b) what (c) which
- 'Will she come?' 'I think ____.' (yes, she will)
(a) so (b) it (c) yes
- 'Will there be problems?' 'I hope ____.' (no)
(a) not (b) no (c) so not
- I've read the report and my colleague ___ too.
(a) has (b) did (c) was
- ___ he said next shocked everyone in the room.
(a) What (b) That (c) Which
- The extent ___ social media affects wellbeing is still debated.
(a) that (b) what (c) to which
- ___ she will accept the offer or not remains uncertain.
(a) If (b) Whether (c) That
- What matters here ___ not quantity but quality of connection.
(a) are (b) were (c) is

10. She passed the exam, and so ___ her younger sister.

- (a) was (b) did (c) passed

11. The ___ that languages differ so profoundly raises important questions.

- (a) fact (b) facts (c) factual

12. He told us ___ the conference had been rescheduled.

- (a) that (b) what (c) whether

13. ___ we know about the brain has transformed dramatically in 20 years.

- (a) What (b) That (c) Which

14. 'Can you help me?' 'I'll try ___.' (to help)

- (a) to (b) so (c) it

15. It goes without ___ that honesty is the foundation of trust.

- (a) saying (b) said (c) to say

5 Writing · Yazma

1. Nominal clause alıştırmaları

Write 4 sentences using these structures:

1-) What... is (nominal subject clause)

2-) The fact that... (nominal clause)

3-) Whether... or not (alternative clause)

4-) The extent to which... (formal nominal clause)

2. Dil ve düşünce

Write 5 sentences on whether you think the language you speak affects how you think. Use ellipsis and substitution to avoid repetition.

✓ Answer Key · Cevap Anahtarı

Exercises

1. **a) What** — Nominal clause as subject: *What + clause + IS* (tekil fiil!) — 'the thing that matters most'
2. **a) that** — The fact that + clause = nominal clause (the lying is the subject's fact)
3. **a) so** — Substitution: *think so = I think she will come* (replaces entire clause)
4. **a) not** — Substitution: *hope not = I hope there will not be problems*
5. **a) has** — Ellipsis: 'has' (read the report too) — avoid repeating the full verb phrase
6. **a) What** — What-clause as subject: 'What he said' = 'The thing he said' (singular)
7. **c) to which** — The extent to which = ne ölçüde (formal nominal clause with preposition)
8. **b) Whether** — Whether + clause as subject (yes/no alternative — formal)
9. **c) is** — What-clause = TEKİL özne → IS (not are!)
10. **b) did** — Ellipsis with inversion: *so + did + subject* (= her sister passed too)
11. **a) fact** — The fact that... = formal nominal clause (established truth)
12. **a) that** — told + that-clause (nominal clause as object of 'told')
13. **a) What** — What-clause as subject: 'What we know' = 'The things we know'
14. **a) to** — Ellipsis with infinitive: *try to* (= try to help) — omit 'help'
15. **a) saying** — Fixed idiom: 'it goes without saying that...' = goes without + V-ing

Comprehension

1. Whether language shapes thought or merely expresses it.
2. According to controversial research, it may lack recursion — the ability to embed one thought inside another.
3. The assumption that language and thought are entirely separable processes.
4. e.g. 'What linguists have long debated' (subject) / 'What this implies' (subject) / 'What we take for granted' (subject) / 'What is certain' (subject)

Writing — örnek cevaplar

Görev 1 — Nominal clause alıştırması

What linguists have long debated is whether language shapes thought. The fact that some languages have no word for "blue" raises fascinating questions. Whether colour perception is truly universal or language-dependent remains contested. The extent to which our mother tongue limits our thinking is what researchers are only beginning to understand.

Görev 2 — Dil ve düşünce

What I find most compelling is the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis — and I believe so too, though cautiously. The fact that different languages encode time differently suggests that thought is not entirely universal. Whether our language constrains us or merely shapes us is a question I cannot answer with certainty. What I do believe is that learning multiple languages expands the mind.

İnteraktif sürüm, anında geri bildirim ve XP için: abonlinenglish.school/ingilizce-c1/unite-1-nominal-clauses-ellipsis-substitution